

Lincolnshire Knee Clinic

Consultant-Led Specialist Knee Care

Total Knee Replacement Recovery Guide

A patient guide for the first 6 weeks post-surgery

Introduction

A total knee replacement is a major surgical procedure. This guide is designed to assist you through the first six weeks of your recovery, helping you regain mobility, manage pain, and protect your new joint.

Weeks 1 - 2: Pain Management & Early Movement

- Prioritise regular pain medication as prescribed. Do not wait for pain to become severe.
- Use ice packs for 15-20 minutes, 4-6 times a day, to reduce swelling.
- Aim to walk short distances hourly with walking aids.
- Focus on straightening the knee fully when resting.

Weeks 3 - 4: Increasing Flexibility

- Gradually increase walking distance as tolerated.
- Work on achieving 90 degrees of knee bending (flexion).
- Continue twice-daily physiotherapy exercises.
- Monitor the wound incision closely for any unexpected discharge or redness.

Weeks 5 - 6: Building Strength

- Begin light stationary cycling if approved by your physiotherapist.
- Focus on independent walking, transitioning off crutches as guided.
- Attend your 6-week outpatient follow-up appointment.